Thunkable: Screens & Components

Design your first app: screens, buttons, labels and more.

Thunkable | Beginner to Intermediate | Ages 10–16

The Big Idea

- Thunkable lets you build real phone apps by dragging and dropping.
- An app is made of screens. Each screen holds components.
- Components are things like buttons, labels, images and text boxes.
- You change how a component looks in the Properties panel.
- You work in two views: Design (how it looks) and Blocks (what it does).

Common Components

- Label: shows text on the screen.
- Button: something the user taps.
- Text Input: a box where the user types.
- Image: shows a picture.
- Switch and Slider: let the user turn things on or off, or pick a value.
- List Viewer: shows a list of items.

Properties You Will Use

- Text: the words on a label or button.
- Font size and colour: how the words look.
- Background colour: the colour behind a component.
- Width and height: how big a component is.
- Visible: show or hide a component.

Screens

- Every app starts with Screen1. You can add more screens with the Add Screen button.
- Give screens clear names, like HomeScreen or ResultScreen.
- Plan your screens on paper first, as a quick sketch.
- Use a Layout component to line things up neatly.

💻 Design Examples

Screen1 of a pet quiz app — Design view

```
Screen1
  Label1       Text: My Pet Quiz       Font size: 28
  Image1       Source: (upload a picture)
  TextInput1   Hint: Type your name
  Button1      Text: Start             Background: #fcd34d
```

▶ **What you see:**
A title at the top, a picture, a name box and a yellow Start button in a column.

Screen2 for the questions — Design view

```
Screen2
  Label1       Text: Question 1
  Label2       Text: What does a cat say?
  TextInput1   Hint: Your answer
  Button1      Text: Check
```

▶ **What you see:**
A question screen the Start button can open.

Tidy layout — Design view

```
Screen1
  Horizontal layout
    Button1   Text: Yes
    Button2   Text: No
```

▶ **What you see:**
Two buttons sitting side by side instead of one under the other.

📚 Key Terms

App
A program that runs on a phone.

Design view
Where you build the look of the app.

Screen
One page of your app.

Blocks view
Where you add the actions.

Component
A thing on a screen, like a button.

Label
A component that shows text.

Properties
Settings that change how a component looks.

Button
A component the user taps.

Text Input
A box for typing.

Layout
A container that arranges components.

🧮 Quick Reference

```
Label1.Text       -> the words on a label
Button1.Text      -> the words on a button
TextInput1.Text   -> what the user typed
Image1.Source     -> which picture shows
Screen2           -> a second page of your app
```

✏️ Worked Examples

Q: Make a welcome screen with a title and a Start button.

A: Step 1: Drag a Label and set Text to the app name. Step 2: Drag a Button and set Text to Start. Step 3: Change the colours and font size in Properties.

Q: Add a name box.

A: Drag a Text Input onto the screen and set its Hint to Type your name. Later, the blocks can read TextInput1.Text.

Q: Add a second screen.

A: Click Add Screen, name it Screen2, then design it. Use a block on Screen1 to open it.

🚫 Common Mistakes

- Leaving components with default names like Button7, then getting confused in blocks.
- Making text too small to read on a phone.
- Putting too many things on one screen.
- Forgetting to set the text of a Button, so it shows the default words.
- Changing Design when you meant to add actions in Blocks.

👨‍👩‍👧 Parent Corner

- Help your child create the Thunkable account and check Thunkable's age and privacy rules.
- Ask your child to sketch the app on paper first.
- Ask: What would the user tap first?

- Talk about good design: big buttons and clear words.
- Keep the first app small, like a greeting or a quiz with one question.

🎯 Quick Check

1. What is a screen?

✅ One page of an app.

2. Which component shows text?

✅ A Label.

3. Where do you change a component's colour?

✅ In the Properties panel.

4. Which view is for what the app looks like?

✅ Design view.

5. Which component lets a user type?

✅ Text Input.